

Something Lurks – A blind navigation experience where players map a sewer using only sound.

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Concept Overview



You play as a **remote operator** guiding a rescue drone through a sewer system. The drone's camera is damaged, eliminating visual input but its audio sensors remain fully functional, allowing you to perceive the environment through sound.

Your only tool is your **sonar pulse**. Every click sends out a ping. What comes back... is all you have. You will have a limited amount of uses of the pulse so don't forget the layout of the maze.

Find out about the people that went **missing** in the sewer.

Game Iteration

Cutting Down the Concept: Backing out on the idea of using compass navigation (North South East West). Removing a grid system like map along with x/y-axis for map traversal.

Prototype Testing Learnings: Initially explored multiple mechanics about trapping the monster as the win condition instead of actually locating the missing people. Refined to focus back on the missing people and surviving the monster instead of trapping it and then escaping without getting caught. Players initially tried to **spam the sonar pulse**, hence the need for cooldown and health points, adding a penalty for crashing into the walls a few too many times.

Gameplay Mechanics

Resource System: When the drone bumps into the wall, the drone takes damage losing HP.

Mapping System: Sonar reveals the surrounding radius around the drone for a few seconds only, which then goes into cooldown.

Threat System: Make sure you identify the heartbeat of normal humans and the clicking sound IT makes. Identify their co-ordinates of the humans and trap the monster in the containment where you spawn with the drone